Your Daily Pizza

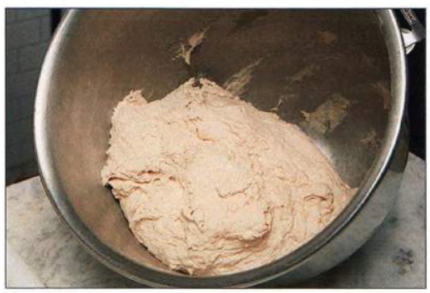
Modern lifestyles don't always make it easy to produce our proverbial daily bread or, in this case, daily pizza. We were inspired by an undemanding daily baking routine created by Jeff Hertzberg and Zoë François. Starting with 2007's *Artisan Bread in Five Minutes a Day*, Hertzberg and François showcased a make-ahead bread technique that became the centerpiece of a best-selling series of cookbooks. They demonstrated how a large batch of dough for almost any type of bread can be stored long-term in the refrigerator, with the baker harvesting a loaf's worth of dough every day for up to two weeks.

Hertzberg and François have refined their methods over time, and we have modified their recipe to make pizza dough with our own improvements while keeping the low-maintenance schedule (see recipes on page 184). We add around 0.22% ascorbic acid to strengthen the dough's gluten network and reduce oxidation, which eventually would make the dough turn gray in the refrigerator. Polydextrose is included in our Neapolitan variation to produce a very crispy crust.

If you have made your first large batch of dough, you can harvest a 500 g / 1.1 lb (or 1 kg / 2.2 lb) piece, divide it (if necessary), preshape and shape it, and then proof it. Accounting for proofing time, the recipe takes more than 5 minutes of effort per day, but with some preplanning this method supplies daily pizza with a fraction of the work.

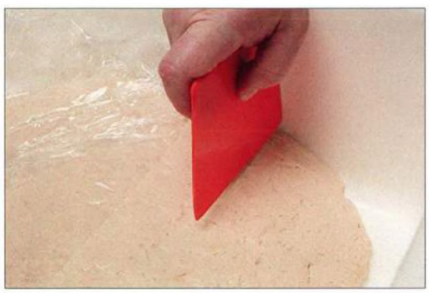
Your Daily Artisan Pizza Dough (see page 184)

HOW TO Make Your Daily Pizza



1 Combine all of the ingredients in the mixer's bowl. Mix on low speed using a paddle or hook attachment to a homogeneous mass, 2–3 min. Transfer to a lightly oiled tub and cover.

2 Bulk ferment for 1 h at 21° C / 70° F. Remove the lid and put a piece of plastic wrap directly on the surface of the dough to cover it completely. Refrigerate for at least 23 h before your first bake.



3 Divide the dough as instructed in the master recipe.

4 Proceed with the preshaping and shaping instructions (if applicable) in the master recipe.

5 Proof for 4½–5½ h at 21° C / 70° F, covered. If you are making Neapolitan pizza dough, proof for 3–4 h at 21° C / 70° F, covered. Proceed with the shaping and baking instructions in the master recipe.

FACTORS THAT AFFECT MIXING TIME

The following table details factors that may affect mixing time and, therefore, your dough. Suggestions for eliminating (or minimizing) any negative effects on your dough are also noted.

Factor	How it can affect your dough	How to keep it from affecting your dough
dough temperature	if the dough is too cold when it comes out of the mixer, it will take longer to ferment than a dough that comes out at our recommended range of 24–25° C / 75–78° F; a dough that comes out too hot (generally 27° C / 80° F and above) will hydrate faster and therefore proof faster, which will affect its flavor and make it harder to handle; warmer doughs are desirable in some cases, such as our Neapolitan pizza dough with poolish and our master Neapolitan pizza dough	for cold dough, adapt your schedule to compensate for the difference in fermenting time; to fix hot dough, put it on a floured sheet pan or in a large tub, and use your hands to flatten it as much as possible; cover it with plastic wrap sheet (or a clean plastic bag), and refrigerate it for at least 10–15 min or until the dough has reached the recommended temperature range
amount of dough in the mixer	too much dough will take longer to mix and increase mixer friction, and too little won't mix well or at all	know the capacity of your mixer and don't overload or underload it; for more on mixer capacity, see page 34
type of flour	some flours, such as whole wheat, contain bran, which can rip the dough; stronger flours take longer to mix; low-gluten flours mix quickly and can break down just as fast; rye flours, in addition to being low gluten, absorb more water than regular wheat flours	understand how each flour is used for different purposes, and choose the flour that's best for the dough you want to make
amount of water	high-hydration doughs take a long time to mix; low-hydration doughs are hard to mix because they're stiff and can bog down the machine	for high-hydration doughs, use the double hydration method (see page 41); for dry, stiff doughs, mix on the lowest speed and/or use a paddle attachment instead of a hook
fats	fats slow down gluten formation and interfere with the bonds that keep gluten together, by coating them and preventing them from hydrating	when possible, add high-fat ingredients after the dough has reached at least low gluten development
inclusions	as with bran, solid inclusions such as nuts and fruit can rip the dough	add solid inclusions after the dough has reached medium gluten development (see page 30)